



2023 Orlando Magic Offseason Plan



Where We Are Today

- 7 Players Under Contract for **\$50,225,364** in 2023-24
 - 2 are expiring contracts
- 4 Non-fully Guaranteed Salaries for 2023-24
- Max Potential Cap Room of **\$56.69M**
- 3 Pending Team Options
- 1 UFA
- 2 2023 First Round Draft Picks (#3 and #5 Overall via CHI)
- 1 2023 Second Round Draft Pick (#35 Overall)

	Guards	Wings	Bigs
Building Blocks		Banchero F. Wagner	
Heavy Rotation	Fultz Anthony Suggs Harris		Carter Jr.
Light Rotation		Okeke Houston	Issac M. Wagner Bol
Developmental - Bench	Carter-Williams	Schofield	Bitadze

Under Contract Free Agent Expiring 23-24 Team Option Non-Guaranteed

OTHER ASSETS

- Draft Picks (2024-2030):** We own all of our FRP and SRP through 2030; Denver Protected FRP in 2025; at least 6 extra SRP through 2028.
- Room MLE**
- 2 Available Two-Way Contracts**

Goals

- Qualify For Play-In Tournament In 2023-24 Season**
- Qualify For Playoffs In 2024-25 Season**
- No Luxury Tax At Least Until Banchero's Rookie Extension**
- Determine Which PGs Will Be with the Franchise Long-Term**

In the next two seasons, we want our young players to play in meaningful basketball games as they continue their development. However, player development will remain our focus, and we don't plan on accelerating our timeline yet. We are still a cheap team, and want to prioritize finding another franchise building block before spending big in free agency or sending away many of our assets in a trade.

Team Needs

- Franchise Building Blocks**
- Wing Depth**
- Backup C**
- 3P Shooting**

Player	2023-24	2024-25	2025-26	2026-27
Wendell Carter Jr.	13,050,000	11,950,000	10,850,000	20,615,000
Paolo Banchero	11,608,080	12,160,800	15,334,769	38,336,923
Jalen Suggs	7,252,080	9,188,385	27,565,155	
Cole Anthony	5,539,771	16,619,313		
Franz Wagner	5,508,720	7,007,092	21,021,276	
Chuma Okeke	5,266,713	15,800,139		
Caleb Houston	2,000,000	2,019,699	2,187,699	6,563,097
Jonathan Issac	17,400,000	17,400,000	33,214,286	
Markelle Fultz	17,000,000	25,500,000		
Gary Harris	13,000,000	19,500,000		
Bol Bol	2,200,000	4,180,000		
Michael Carter-Williams	3,051,144	2,156,156		
Goga Bitadze	2,066,585	2,156,156		
Admiral Schofield	1,997,238	2,156,156		
Mo Wagner	1,855,319			
2023 Pick 3	9,625,800	10,106,760	10,588,320	13,383,636
2023 Pick 5	7,858,920	8,251,560	8,644,560	10,952,658
2023 Pick 35				
	UFA	RFA	Rookie TO	TO
		PO	Non-Guaranteed	

Our main focus will be to find more players we think can be a part of our long-term future that can complement Banchero (and to a lesser extent F. Wagner). Our best chance of doing this will be through the draft. We also have significant cap space, and will use it to fill holes on our roster. We will look for young players with upside, as well as veterans who can help us compete towards our goals, without disrupting the development of our young core pieces. We are willing to spend in free agency to compete for playoff spots the next two years, but will be very hesitant when considering spending on a long-term contract.

2023 NBA Draft Big Board



#1: [VICTOR WEMBANYAMA](#)

France – C – 7'2" – 19 y/o

Widely touted as a generational prospect... Unprecedented combination of size, length, and skill... Great coordination and agility for his size... Versatile player on both ends of the court... Thin frame causes injury concern...



#2: [SCOOT HENDERSON](#)

G-League – PG – 6'2" – 19 y/o

Explosive and confident lead guard... Long arms and solid frame... Strong when driving and finishing at the rim... Improved his 3P shot this season but still inconsistent... Good playmaking... Inconsistent defender with upside...



#3: [BRANDON MILLER](#)

Alabama – SF – 6'9" – 20 y/o

Talented, lanky Forward with good athleticism... Efficient 3P shooter... Doesn't need much space to get shots off due to his length and quick release... Physical rebounder... Competitive defender... Willing to pass but not a good playmaker...



#4: [AMEN THOMPSON](#)

Overtime Elite – SG – 6'7" – 20 y/o

Combo guard with incredible athleticism and good size... Fast with the ball and very quick first step on dribble drive... Promising playmaker... Very solid defender... Poor shooting limits upside... Questions about competition levels in OTE...



#5: [ANTHONY BLACK](#)

Arkansas – PG – 6'7" – 19 y/o

Great size for a combo guard... High-level playmaker with great floor vision... Good defender who can guard multiple position... Struggles as a shooter... Lots of turnovers due to telegraphed passes and forced reads... Lacks explosiveness...

We feel that there is a large gap between the 2nd and 3rd prospects on our board, and so our first goal this draft will be to trade for the 2nd overall pick from the Pistons. We anticipate that they may prefer to draft Miller, considering their current roster construction and recent draft picks, and many people believe that Miller has been rapidly closing the gap on the #2 prospect spot. Because of these circumstances, we believe that they would be willing to move down a spot if they can get additional draft compensation to select Miller. We do have some hesitations about Henderson's fit due to his lack of shooting, but ultimately believe that he can fill a hole on our roster as an elite ball dominant guard.

When considering players that could be available for our pick at #5 overall, we see lots of players that could have significant fit issues on our roster, especially since we plan on adding Henderson. Therefore, we decided that we also would like to trade the 5th pick, this time, we'd like to trade down though. We identified Keyonte George as a player who we think could be an ideal fit with Banchero, Henderson, and Wagner. We think his explosive scoring ability, especially his 3P shooting, could be an outstanding backcourt match pairing with Henderson. We think multiple teams would be interested in trading up to the top-5 for players like either Thompson brother or Jarace Walker, and would listen to offers even if it puts us out of range to select George. We identified the Wizards, at pick number 8, as one of those teams, and will try to get a deal done with them.

Starting with our move to trade down, we would trade our 5th overall pick for the Wizards 8th overall pick in exchange for their top-10 protected 2024 FRP. Next, we would use that 2024 WAS top-10 protected FRP and Denver's 2025 top-5 protected FRP (and add top-10 protection onto it for our benefit) to trade with the Pistons from the 3rd to 2nd pick. This would put us in a great position to draft our targets (Henderson and George) while only sending out a protected 2025 FRP that we have from DEN.

Lastly during the Draft, we have the 35th overall pick as well. Ricky Council IV and Azuolas Tubelis are players that we have interest in and believe could be available at this spot. Since we have two open two-way roster spots, we intend on signing the 35th overall pick to one of them, and using the other on an undrafted player.

Key Decisions

[JONATHAN ISSAC](#)

\$17.4M if not waived - \$7.6M guaranteed if waived

After appearing in just 45 total games in the last 4 seasons combined, we can no longer count on him to be a part of our franchise long-term. However, his contract does not become fully guaranteed until 1/10/24. Because we don't plan on needing the cap space or roster spot immediately, we will not waive him for now. Throughout this season, we will monitor his progress and will be open to waiving or trading him mid-season.

[MARKELLE FULTZ](#)

\$17.0M if not waived - \$2.0M guaranteed if waived

We will not be waiving Fultz, but since our backcourt is becoming very crowded, he may not be a part of our long-term future. We will use this season to see how Fultz can play off-ball alongside Henderson, as well as taking backup PG duties. If we don't see him fitting in with this roster, we will explore trading him.

[GARY HARRIS](#)

\$13.0M if not waived - \$0.0M guaranteed if waived

Harris is on a good contract given his production and is one of our best 3P shooters, so we will not waive him. However, like Fultz, he is in a crowded backcourt now. We think his \$13M of salary could be better used filling out other parts of our team, but would rather trade him than waive him. The player we have in mind is Doug McDermott. He is on an extremely similar contract to Harris and is also expiring after this season. Adding McDermott could boost our wing depth and improve our shooting, two of our main offseason goals. We would offer SA Harris, a future SRP, and cash considerations for McDermott.

[BOL BOL OR GOGA BITADZE](#)

\$2.2M salary for Bol - \$2.1M salary for Bitadze

We would like to bring back either Bitadze or Bol as a developmental center, but not both. Neither is guaranteed any money this upcoming season. We will bring back Bol and decline Bitadze's team option since Bol is more versatile and we feel more confident that he could contribute more on nights where he is needed.

[MICHAEL CARTER-WILLIAMS](#)

\$3.1M if not waived - \$0.0M guaranteed if waived

Not enough room in our crowded backcourt, and we need the roster spot for depth elsewhere, so we will not pick up his team option.

[ADMIRAL SCHOFIELD](#)

\$2.1M if not waived - \$0.0M guaranteed if waived

We don't see a path for many minutes for him this season, and don't see the upside to warrant keeping him around, so we will not pick up his team option.

Free Agency

After the draft (where we signed our two FRP to 120% of the rookie scale amount) and after making our decisions on non-guaranteed contracts and team options, we have 13 rostered players (2 available roster spots) and **\$14,857,756** in cap room. This could be increased by \$1,878,720 if we renounce our rights on our only pending free agent: Mo Wagner. As noted in our Key Decision section, we can also waive J. Issac until 1/10/24 to free up another \$10M in cap room. Lastly, we have our Room Mid-Level Exception (\$6M) still available.

Our main priority will be to sign a backup center. At the position, we currently have Wendell Carter Jr. and Bol Bol signed. We believe that Carter Jr. can be the starting center for us on a team that qualifies for the playoffs within the next two years, but we don't believe we can rely on Bol to be a consistent contributor at this time, so we really need another Big that can be trusted in the rotation. Our two targets for this role are Naz Reid and our own free agent Mo Wagner. We slightly prefer Reid and will pursue him first. He is a physical and athletic big man that can contribute on both ends of the floor. His versatility and energy could provide valued consistency coming off the bench, but he is also talented enough to start and play heavy minutes when needed. We will offer Reid a 2-year contract with an additional 3rd year Team-Option, with a first-year value up to \$11M, with a 5% decline in value each year of the contract. If Reid joins our franchise, we will renounce the rights we have on M. Wagner, and have \$5.75M left in cap room and one open roster spot.

If we do not sign Reid, we will not renounce M. Wagner, but instead try to sign him to a new contract. He has show he can be a consistent backup big in the league, and he fits with our timeline and young core players. We will offer him a 2-year plus 1-year team option with a value of \$8M each season for the length of the contract. After signing a backup big, we have one roster spot remaining and will chose to leave it open for the time being. With the depth we currently have, we wouldn't want to add a veteran to help us with our playoff push the next two years at the expense of pushing any of our young players further down the depth chart. Instead, we think trying to find a GL or Euro call up could be a better use for the spot, or using it to take a salary dump from another team in exchange for a SRP.

Note: Earlier, we stated that we would try to trade Gary Harris for Doug McDermott. If we were not able to accomplish this, we would need to add more wing depth in free agency. Potential targets would include Bruce Brown, Harrison Barnes, and Jae Crowder.

Looking Forward

Coming into this offseason, our goals were to add more long-term players to our roster while improving enough to make the play-in tournament this upcoming season. We were able to add Henderson and George with some maneuvering at the Draft, and now feel we have 3 true franchise cornerstones that are all on the same timeline. We also filled out our depth by trading for Doug McDermott and signing Naz Reid. None of these moves impacted our future flexibility significantly, and we believe we are now in a position to be competing for playoff spots the next couple of years as our young player continue to develop.

While adding Henderson and George to our backcourt did add some building blocks that we were seeking, it also muddled up an already crowded backcourt. Fultz is the best player in our backcourt currently, and we'd love to keep him around on this team, but need to use this year to evaluate how he can co-exist with Henderson before his upcoming free agency next offseason. Anthony and Suggs will also be a part of the rotation this season and we can work on assessing their long term fit as well, but we don't see us being willing to pay what they will likely demand on the open market just to use them as depth in the rotation.

Not just in the guard position, but we do have solid depth over the entire roster. We have 11 players who would expect consistent and significant playing time when healthy. We are counting on development from our young players (specifically Henderson and Banchero) to eventually turn into the elite level talent which we are currently lacking, but because of our roster construction, we may also be able to acquire top-end talent via trade the next time a disgruntled superstar becomes available. We have all of our own draft assets looking into the future, and many young promising players on team friendly contracts. This will be something we monitor heavily.

After another season prioritizing internal growth from our young players, hopefully we will have a play-in berth to show from it. Going into next offseason we will have a better idea of which young players we want to be a long-term part of the future and which players we are ready to move on from. In free agency next year, we will be able to prioritize signing impactful veterans to help with the 2024-25 playoff push, with an expected emphasis on 3P shooting.

Player	2023-24	2024-25	2025-26	2026-27
Jonathan Issac	17,400,000	17,400,000	33,214,286	
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Doug McDermott	13,750,000	20,625,000		
Wendell Carter Jr.	13,050,000	11,950,000	10,850,000	20,615,000
Paolo Banchero	11,608,080	12,160,800	15,334,769	38,336,923
Naz Reid	11,000,000	10,450,000	9,900,000	18,810,000
Scout Henderson	10,718,760	11,254,920	11,790,960	14,880,192
Jalen Suggs	7,252,080	9,188,385	27,565,155	
Keyonte George	5,969,400	6,268,080	6,566,520	8,352,613
Cole Anthony	5,539,771	16,619,313		
Franz Wagner	5,508,720	7,007,092	21,021,276	
Chuma Okeke	5,266,713	15,800,139		
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Bol Bol	2,200,000	4,180,000		
	UFA	RFA	Rookie TO	TO
		PO	Non-Guaranteed	

PG	SG	SF	PF	C
Henderson	Fultz	Wagner	Banchero	Carter Jr.
Anthony	George	McDermott	Issac	Reid
	Suggs	Houston		Bol
	Okeke			